Float



Category: **Construction & Masonry** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 6 labs

Covers these lab items: Metal Float; Wooden Float

What it is used for

Use a construction float to smooth, level, or finish fresh mortar, plaster, or concrete surfaces as appropriate for the tool type.

How to use

1. Choose a wooden or metal float suitable for the material and finishing stage.
2. Inspect the working face and handle for damage, loose parts, or hardened residue.
3. Prepare the surface and confirm the material is ready for floating.
4. Hold the float firmly and place its face flat against the surface.
5. Move the float in controlled overlapping strokes without removing excessive material.
6. Check the surface level and finish, adjusting pressure as needed.
7. Clean the float before material hardens and store it safely.

⚠ Safety

- Wear gloves, eye protection, and suitable footwear when handling cement-based materials.
- Avoid direct skin contact with wet cement or mortar.
- Keep the work area clear to prevent slips and trips.
- Do not use a damaged float or work from an unstable platform.

Care & storage

- Wash off mortar or concrete residue immediately after use.
- Dry the float and store it in a clean place to prevent corrosion or damage.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.